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Q I am a regular reader of this column and have been using Linux for the last few months. I would like to thank *LINUX For You* magazine for introducing me to this wonderful community.

I have a query. For one of my requirements I used to open the Windows' File browser for the command line by just typing 'explorer' and pressing *Enter*.

Can you please let me know if there is any way to open the File browser from the command line (terminal) in Linux too? I would also like to know how to open some applications, such as the Web browser, from the terminal.

—Arpita,
arpita2233@gmail.com

Yes, you can surely do that using Linux too. If you are using a GNOME version, then just open the terminal and type the following command:

```
$nautilus .
```

If the desktop environment is KDE 4, then type in...

```
$dolphin .
```

To open the Web browser from the terminal, you can type 'Firefox' (if that is installed) and press *Enter*. You can even use *xdg-open*. It is used to open a file or URL in the user's preferred application. If a URL is provided, the URL will be opened in the user's default Web browser. For example, the command given below will open www.linuxforu.com in Firefox, if that's your default Web browser.

```
$ xdg-open http://linuxforu.com/
```

Q I recently purchased your magazine, which had a DVD of Ubuntu 10.10. I have installed it on my computer. Although the sound system is working fine on my computer, I am unable to play many of my music as well as video files. My desktop has an Intel Core 2 Duo processor and 2 GB of RAM with lots of free HDD space. Please suggest some solution so that I can play my MP3 music and other video files on it.

—Prasad Shirke,
prasad.shirke@gmail.com

A. Installing support for MP3 in Ubuntu is easy. All you need to do is connect your computer to the Internet and try playing any MP3 file. As soon as you double click the file, Totem will try to play the MP3 file. But if it is unable to play the file due to some missing codecs, it will ask you if you want to search for the appropriate codec. Click on *Search* to continue, and follow the on-screen instructions to complete the installation. Now enjoy the music!

People without an Internet connection while working on Ubuntu can download the necessary files from some other computer and install it on to their computers, offline. For offline installation you can use Keryx. This can be downloaded from http://launchpad.net/keryx/stable/0.92/+download/keryx_0.92.4.1.zip.

Unzip the software on a Flash drive attached to your USB port. If the Internet connected computer has Windows installed on it, then go to the Keryx/win32 directory on your Flash drive and double-click the Keryx or Keryx.exe icon to run the application. If the Internet connected computer is running on a Linux OS, navigate to the Keryx/Linux directory on your Flash drive and double-click the Keryx icon to launch the software. A detailed list of steps on how to use the software can be found in the tutorial included in the doc folder of the extracted software.

Q I have a few computers in my lab that are running on Linux and a few others that run on Windows XP. Please let me know if there's a method to share data between computers that run on Windows and those that have a Linux OS installed on them. Also, can I mount a Windows shared folder on my Linux box?

—Amit Singh, amit1986@gmail.com

You can configure Samba and share data between your computers. More details can be found at <http://www.samba.org/samba/docs/>. To mount the Windows shared folder, follow the steps given below. Please do remember to do this as the root user.

Make a directory that will work as the mount point:

```
# mkdir -p /mnt/win
```

Now mount the Windows shared folder using the following command:

```
# mount -t cifs -o username=windowsuser,password=mypassword //<windows_Computer_IP_or_Name>/sharename /mnt/win
# cd /mnt/win
# ls -l
```

This will show the content of the Windows' shared folder.

